

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

Phase 2: Requirement Analysis

2.1 Business Requirements

Requirement	Description
Incident Creation	Service Desk agents should be able to log incidents quickly and consistently.
Incident Classification	Every incident should capture category, subcategory, urgency, service, and configuration item so it's routed correctly from the start.
Knowledge Management Integration	Agents should be able to view and attach relevant knowledge articles to speed up resolution.
Assignment & Reassignment	Incidents should be routable to the correct support group, with the ability to reassign to Level 2 teams when needed.
Escalation & Investigation	Level 2 technicians should have full visibility into incident details, history, and SLA status to investigate and resolve effectively.
Change Integration	Incidents requiring a technical fix should support direct creation and linking of emergency change requests.
Child Incident Tracking	Recurring or related issues should be trackable through child incidents linked to a parent ticket.
Resolution Documentation	Cause and resolution details should be captured before an incident is closed.
Knowledge Article Generation	Resolved incidents should be convertible into knowledge articles for future reuse.
SLA & Compliance Visibility	SLA status should remain visible throughout the incident lifecycle to support compliance tracking and reporting.

2.2 Functional Requirements

FR-01: Service Creation

- **Service:** Remote Access
- **Operational Status:** Operational

FR-02: Service Offering Creation

- **Service Offering:** Corporate VPN
- **Parent Service:** Remote Access
- **Operational Status:** Operational

FR-03: Incident Creation

Service Desk agents should be able to create an incident capturing:

- Short Description
- Caller
- Assignment Group
- Description
- Channel
- Category
- Subcategory
- Urgency
- Service
- Service Offering
- Configuration Item

FR-04: Incident Classification

Incidents should be classified with accurate values:

- **Category:** Network
- **Subcategory:** VPN
- **Urgency:** 2 – Medium
- **Service:** Remote Access
- **Service Offering:** Corporate VPN
- **Configuration Item:** an assigned workstation asset

FR-05: Knowledge Integration

Agent Assist should surface relevant knowledge articles based on the incident description. Agents should be able to:

- View recommended articles
- Open an article
- Mark an article as Helpful
- Attach the article to the incident
- Add comments regarding the article

FR-06: Watch List and Work Notes

The system should allow stakeholders to be added to:

- Watch List
- Work Notes List

This keeps relevant people informed without transferring ownership of the ticket.

FR-07: Reassignment

Incidents should be re-assignable from Service Desk to the appropriate Level 2 group

Example: **Service Desk** → **Network**

FR-08: Investigation

Level 2 support should be able to:

- View full incident details
- Review knowledge articles
- Review activity history
- View SLA information
- Take ownership of the incident

FR-09: Change Integration

When resolving an incident requires a technical change, the system should support creating and linking an emergency change request. The incident should be placeable in:

- **State:** On Hold
- **Reason:** Awaiting Change

FR-10: Child Incident

The system should allow creation of child incidents for recurring or related issues, linked back to the parent incident.

FR-11: Cause Documentation

The probable cause of the incident should be documented

Example: a suspended service that required a restart.

FR-12: Resolution Documentation

The system should record:

- **Resolution Code:** Workaround provided)
- **Resolution Notes:** service restarted per the linked change request)

FR-13: Knowledge Article Creation

After resolution, the incident should support generating a knowledge article:

- **Knowledge Base:** IT
- **Template:** Standard
- Article should reflect the incident's resolution details

FR-14: SLA Tracking

SLA information should remain visible throughout the incident lifecycle via related records, supporting ongoing compliance tracking.